



PACT

Personal Action & Commitment Tracker

User Guide · Version 1.0.0

Success is not never missing.
Success is **returning** to the behavior.

A personal behavioural coach for Android that reminds you at the moment you planned, then asks one question: are you doing this now, coming back to it later, or letting it go today?

Works entirely offline · No account · No internet permission · Android 8.0 and newer

Contents

Getting started

- 1 What PACT is, and what it is not
- 2 Installing the app
- 3 First run: the two permissions that matter
- 4 Testing your reminders
- 5 Onboarding

Setting things up

- 6 Creating a goal
- 7 Creating a behavior
- 8 Schedules and times of day
- 9 The minimum action
- 10 What a behavior means each day
- 11 Reminder sound, vibration and insistence
- 12 Recovery settings

Daily use

- 13 The intervention screen

- 14 COMMIT
- 15 RECOVER
- 16 PASS
- 17 Answering from the notification
- 18 The Home dashboard
- 19 The Today timeline

Looking back

- 20 Insights and the recovery score
- 21 The weekly review
- 22 The calendar
- 23 Skips, pauses and holidays

Housekeeping

- 24 Settings
- 25 Backup: export and import
- 26 When reminders do not arrive
- 27 Reference: states and symbols

ABOUT THE PICTURES IN THIS GUIDE

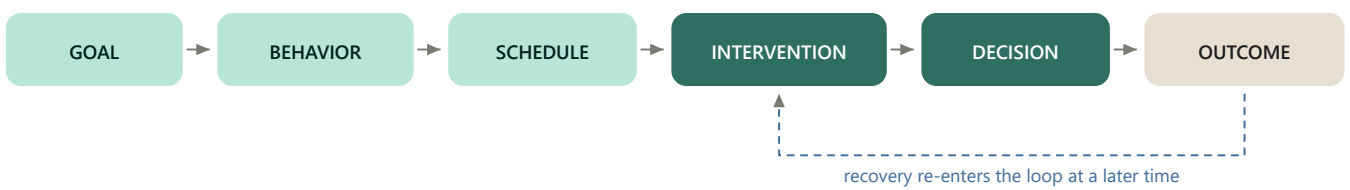
The screens shown throughout are **illustrations**, drawn to match the app's real layout, colours and wording rather than photographed from a phone. Small spacing details may differ slightly from what you see on your own device; every label, button and message is taken from the app itself.

What PACT is, and what it is not

Most habit apps count streaks. PACT is built around a different claim: the thing that decides whether a behaviour survives is not whether you ever miss it, but whether you come back to it after you do.

So PACT does not ask "did you keep the chain going?". It asks, at the moment you planned to act, what you are actually going to do about it — and it treats *coming back later* as a real, tracked, respectable answer rather than a failure.

The loop



The vocabulary

Term	What it means
Goal	The reason. " <i>Improve my physical fitness.</i> " A goal never has a time; it is the why.
Behavior	The thing that actually moves the goal. " <i>Exercise.</i> " One goal can have many.
Schedule	When the behavior happens. " <i>06:30 and 18:00, every day.</i> "
Occurrence	One specific slot. " <i>Exercise, Monday, 06:30.</i> " Each is tracked separately, so your morning session and your evening session have their own histories.
Intervention	The alarm and the screen that asks you to decide.
Decision	Commit, recover, or pass. Always yours.

What PACT deliberately does not do

- No random rewards, points, gems, or variable-ratio mechanics.
- No shaming language, guilt-trips, or "you broke your streak!" notifications.
- No leaderboards, sharing, or social pressure.
- No account, no cloud sync, and no internet permission at all.
- No cloud AI. The coaching is local rules over your own numbers, and it never claims insight the data does not support.

AUTONOMY IS THE RULE

Even the most insistent reminder setting always offers a visible way out. PACT will never lock you into a screen, and it never changes your schedule without you tapping to approve it.

Installing the app

PACT is distributed as a single APK file. There is no Play Store listing, so you install it yourself — a process Android calls "sideloading".

What you need

- An Android phone running **8.0 (Oreo) or newer**.
- The file `PACT-1.0.0.apk` (about 1.9 MB).

The APK is *universal*: it contains code for all four common processor types (arm64-v8a, armeabi-v7a, x86, x86_64), so the same file works on essentially any phone.

Method A — without a cable (easiest)

- 1 Get the APK onto the phone: email it to yourself, put it in Google Drive or OneDrive, or copy it over USB.
- 2 Open your phone's **Files** app and tap the APK.
- 3 Android will say the app is from an **unknown source** and offer a settings toggle. Allow your file manager (or browser) to install unknown apps, then go back and confirm.
- 4 Tap **Install**, then **Open**.

THAT WARNING IS NORMAL

Android shows the unknown-source warning for *any* app not delivered by a store. It is not a sign that something is wrong with PACT. It is Android telling you, correctly, that nobody has vetted this file except you.

Method B — over USB with adb

On the phone, unlock Developer options: **Settings** → **About phone**, then tap **Build number** seven times. Go to **Developer options** and turn on **USB debugging**. Plug the phone in and accept the "Allow USB debugging?" prompt.

Then, on the computer:

```
adb devices
```

 — your phone should be listed as `device`

```
adb install -r PACT-1.0.0.apk
```

The `-r` flag reinstalls over an existing copy while keeping its data.

BEFORE YOU RELY ON IT

Your history lives only on the phone. PACT switches off Android's automatic cloud backup on purpose, so nothing is copied to your Google account. Use **Settings** → **Export data** from time to time, and keep the file somewhere safe. See chapter 25.

Updating later

Install the newer APK the same way. Android keeps your data as long as the new file is signed with the same key as the one already installed. If you ever see "*App not installed*" on an update, that is a signature mismatch — export your data first, uninstall, then install the new version.

First run: the two permissions that matter

This is the most important page in the guide. Android grants neither of these automatically, and without them your reminders will be late or will not arrive at all.

1. Notifications

PACT asks for this once, on first launch. Tap **Allow**. Without it the app cannot show you anything when a behavior comes due — the alarm still fires, but silently and invisibly.

If you dismissed the prompt by accident, you can re-enable it in Android's own settings: **Settings** → **Apps** → **PACT** → **Notifications**.

2. Alarms & reminders

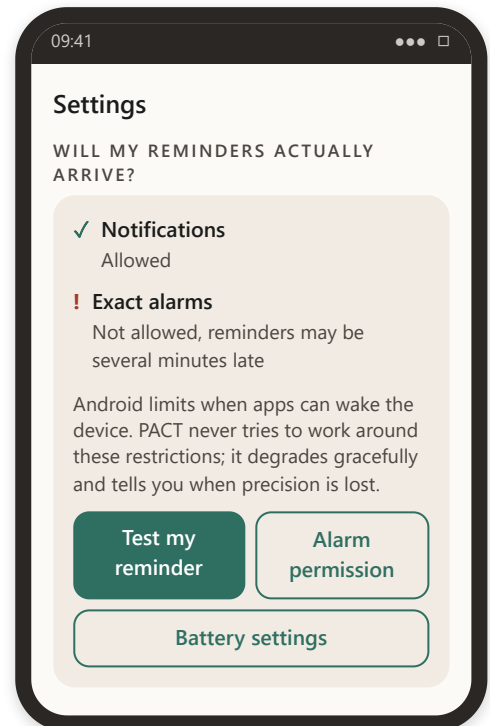
This is the one people miss. Since Android 12, apps must ask separately for permission to fire an alarm at an *exact* minute. PACT does not ask for it automatically, because that would be a pushy first-run experience — you grant it from inside the app.

Go to **Settings** in PACT, find "Will my reminders actually arrive?", and tap **Alarm permission**. Android opens its own screen; turn on *Allow setting alarms and reminders*.

Without it PACT still works, but it falls back to a ten-minute window: a 06:30 reminder may arrive any time between 06:30 and 06:40. The Settings screen tells you which mode you are currently in.

3. Battery optimisation (phone-dependent)

Some manufacturers aggressively kill background apps to save battery. If your phone is a **Xiaomi, Samsung, Huawei, OnePlus, Oppo, Vivo** or similar, also allow PACT to run unrestricted: tap **Battery settings** on the same screen, find PACT, and choose *Unrestricted* (the wording varies by brand).



Settings shows exactly which mode you are in. A red ! means precision has been lost.

THIS IS THE SINGLE MOST COMMON CAUSE OF MISSED REMINDERS

It is not a bug in PACT and no app can reliably work around it. If reminders stop arriving after a day or two of not opening the app, aggressive battery management is almost always why.

Testing your reminders

Do this before you trust the app with anything that matters. It takes fifteen seconds and it is the only honest way to know reminders work on *your* phone.

Go to **Settings** and tap **Test my reminder**. PACT schedules a genuine alarm about fifteen seconds into the future, through exactly the same machinery a real reminder uses — same alarm, same notification channel, same intervention screen.

What you should see

1. A confirmation: "*A test reminder will arrive in about 15 seconds.*"
2. About fifteen seconds later, a notification appears with **Commit**, **Later** and **Pass** actions.
3. Your chosen sound plays and the phone vibrates, if you have those enabled.
4. Tapping the notification opens the full intervention screen.

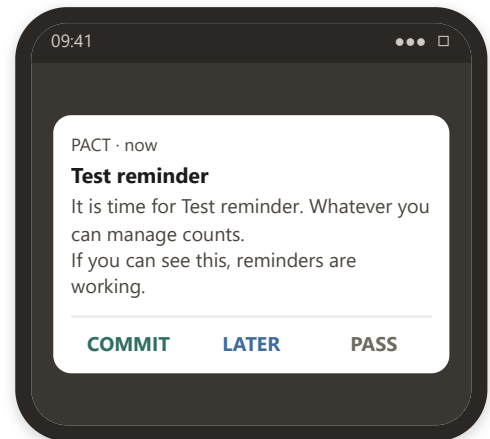
If the message says "may be several minutes late"

The exact-alarm permission is not granted. Go back to chapter 3 and turn it on. The test will still fire, just imprecisely.

If nothing arrives at all

- Check notifications are allowed for PACT in Android's settings.
- Check the phone is not in Do Not Disturb or a focus mode.
- Check battery optimisation, as described in chapter 3.

Afterwards, tap **Remove test reminders**. This deletes the temporary test behavior so it never appears in your statistics.



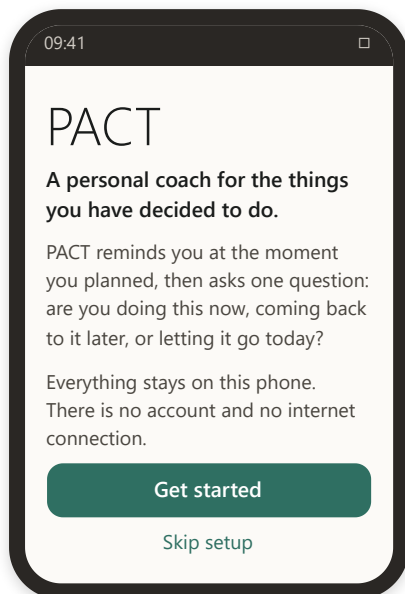
The test notification. The three actions are the same ones every real reminder carries.

RE-TEST AFTER A PHONE UPDATE

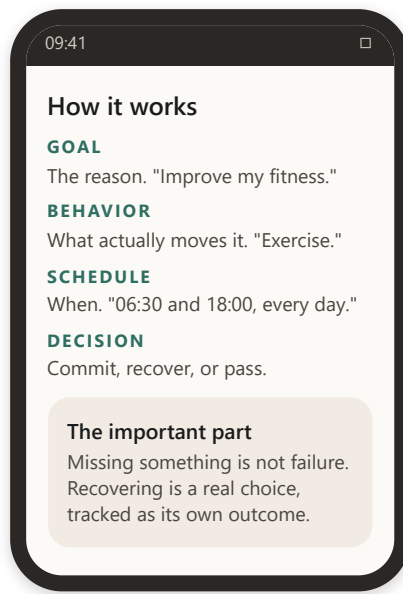
Android updates and manufacturer software updates sometimes reset battery and alarm permissions. If reminders quietly stop, run the test again first — it will usually tell you what changed.

Onboarding

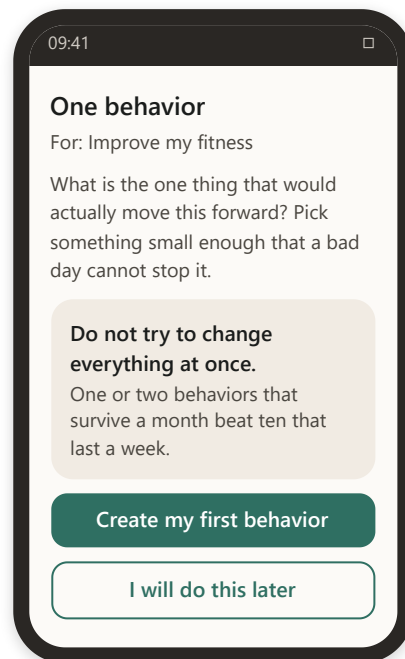
The first time you open PACT it walks you through four short screens. You can skip it and set things up yourself, but the third and fourth screens contain the one piece of advice most worth taking.



Step 1 — Welcome



Step 2 — The concept



Step 4 — The advice worth taking

START WITH ONE OR TWO BEHAVIORS

This is not modesty, it is arithmetic. Ten new behaviours means ten chances a day to feel like you are failing, and people abandon the whole system rather than one item. One behaviour that survives a month is worth more than ten that last a week — and you can always add more once the first is genuinely automatic.

Creating a goal

A goal is the *why*. It never has a time and you never tick it off. Its job is to give the behaviours underneath it a reason to exist — and to appear on the intervention screen at 06:30 when you would rather go back to sleep.

Open the **Goals** tab and tap the **Goal** button.

What to write

Field	Guidance
What is the goal?	Plain language, present tense. <i>"Improve my physical fitness."</i> Not a task, and not something you could finish this afternoon.
Why does it matter?	The field that earns its keep. This text is shown to you when a reminder fires. Write the honest reason, not the presentable one.
Notes	Optional. Anything you want to remember about the goal itself.
Category	Pick a suggestion or type your own. Categories are free text; you are never restricted to the built-in list.
Priority	Low, Medium, High or Critical. Used for ordering and for conflict warnings.

WRITE THE "WHY" FOR A TIRED VERSION OF YOURSELF

"Because I want to be healthy" persuades nobody at 06:30.
"Because I could not keep up with my kids at the park" does. This is the sentence the app shows you at the exact moment it is hardest to act.

Status

Once a goal exists you can set it to **Active**, **Paused**, **Completed** or **Archived**. Paused and archived goals stay in your history but drop out of the way.

Deleting a goal

Deleting a goal **does not delete its behaviours or their history**. They are detached and carry on as unassigned behaviours. This is deliberate: tidying up a goal should never cost you months of records.

09:41

New goal

What is the goal?
Improve my physical fitness

Why does it matter?
I could not keep up with the kids at the park

This is shown when a reminder fires, so make it honest.

CATEGORY

Health Fitness Learning Career

Personal

PRIORITY

Low Medium High Critical

Create goal

Creating a goal. Four fields; only the first two really matter.

CHAPTER 7

Creating a behavior

A behavior is the thing you actually do. It is the longest form in the app, but the first screenful is enough for most behaviours — everything below it has a sensible default.

Start from a template

If you are creating your first behaviours, the template chips at the top prefill the whole form: *Morning exercise*, *Evening reading*, *Drink water*, *Plan tomorrow*, *Weekly review*. They are ordinary editable starting points, and you can save your own with **Save as template**.

Name and goal

Name it as an action: *Exercise*, *Read*, *Prepare teaching materials*. PACT warns if you already have a behavior with that name. Attach it to a goal, or choose **No goal** — unattached behaviours work perfectly well.

What kind of behavior is this?

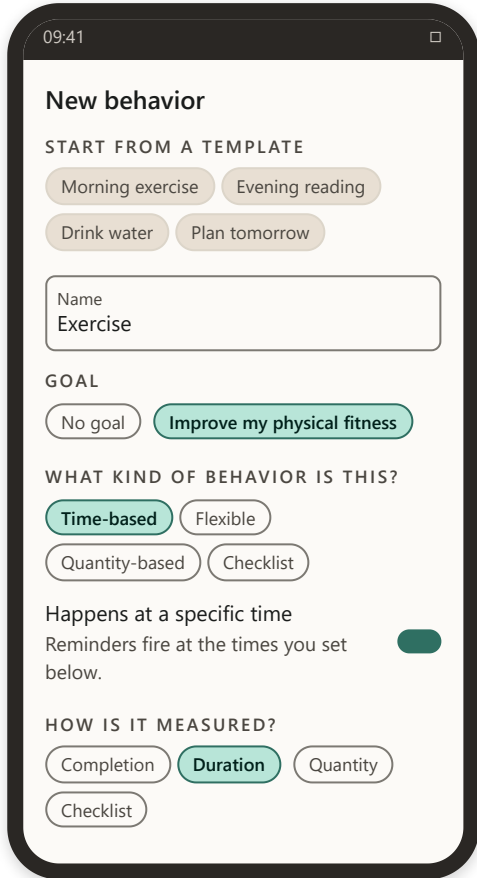
Four presets, each setting two underlying switches you can still change afterwards:

Type	Means
Time-based	Fires an alarm at a set clock time. Measured by duration. <i>Exercise at 06:30 for 30 minutes.</i>
Flexible	No alarm. Just needs doing sometime today. <i>Stretch at some point.</i>
Quantity	Counts an amount rather than time. <i>Drink 2 litres. Read 20 pages. Walk 7,000 steps.</i>
Checklist	A list of items to tick off. <i>Morning routine: water, exercise, shower, read.</i>

The two switches underneath — **Happens at a specific time** and **How is it measured** — are independent. A checklist can be anchored to 06:30; a duration behavior can float across the day. The four types are just convenient presets.

Importance and difficulty

Importance feeds conflict warnings (two high-importance behaviours at the same time gets a louder warning). Difficulty is for your own reference and future analysis. Neither changes how reminders fire.



The top of the behavior editor. This much is enough for most behaviours.

Schedules and times of day

How often, and at what times. The two questions are separate: *how often* chooses the days, *at what times* chooses the moments within those days.

How often?

Option	Behaviour
Once	A single day, then done.
Every day	Daily, no exceptions.
Weekdays	Monday to Friday.
Weekends	Saturday and Sunday.
Chosen days	Pick any combination. <i>Mon / Wed / Fri for the gym.</i>
Every N days	Every 2 days, every 10 days. Counted from the start date, so the rhythm stays stable.
N times a week	Three sessions a week, no fixed days. PACT spreads the slots evenly across the week rather than bunching them on Monday.

Several times a day

Add as many times as you need. This is worth understanding properly:

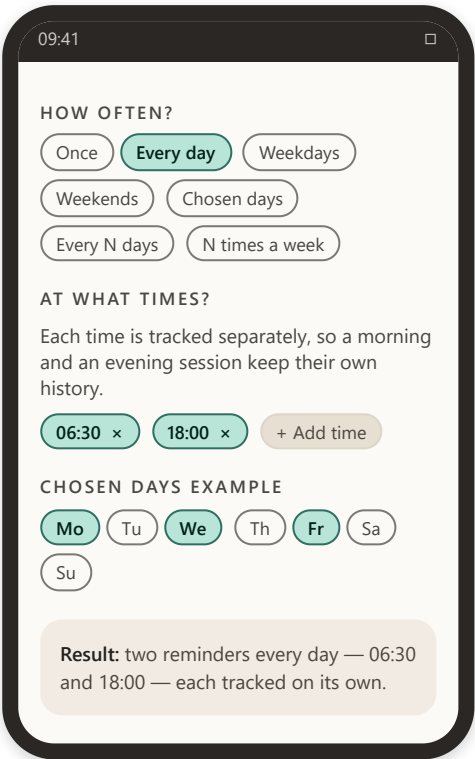
EACH TIME IS ITS OWN OCCURRENCE

Exercise at 06:30 and 18:00 is **two separate occurrences** every day, each with its own alarm, its own decision and its own history. Completing the morning one has no effect on the evening one, and the statistics can tell you that you finish mornings 90% of the time and evenings 40% — which is exactly the kind of thing worth knowing.

Tap a time chip to change it, tap the × to remove it, tap + **Add time** for another. A behavior can have up to twelve times a day.

For flexible behaviours

If *Happens at a specific time* is off, you get a single field instead: **How many times a day?** Those occurrences have no alarm and no clock time — they simply appear under *Anytime today* and you tick them off when you do them.



Times of day. Two chips here means two independent occurrences daily.

The minimum action

Possibly the most useful single feature in PACT, and the one most people skip past. Set it.

Every duration or quantity behavior can define two numbers:

Target	What you are aiming for on a normal day. <i>30 minutes.</i>
Minimum	The floor you can always manage, even on the worst day. <i>5 minutes.</i>

What it does

When a reminder fires, the intervention screen shows the minimum explicitly, as an offer, before you have decided anything:

"You do not have to do the full session. Your minimum is 5 min."

Just do the minimum

One tap and the occurrence is complete. Not as a consolation prize — it is recorded as a genuine completion, with a note that it was the minimum rather than the full target.

Why this matters

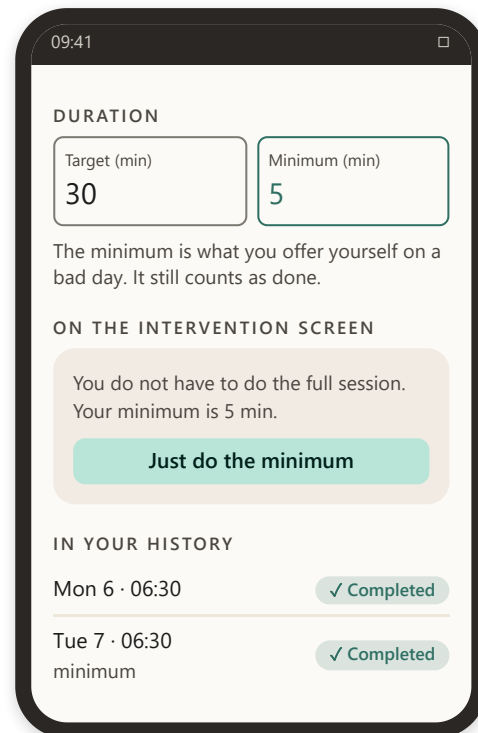
A bad day usually produces a *miss*, and a miss produces the feeling that the whole thing has slipped, which produces another miss. The minimum action interrupts that: five minutes is almost never impossible, and it keeps the behaviour alive on exactly the days that would otherwise break it.

What PACT does with it later

Minimum completions are counted separately from full ones. If most of your completions are the minimum, the coach eventually says so:

"73% of your Exercise completions are the minimum rather than the full target. Lowering the target, or ramping it up gradually, may fit better."

That is a useful signal. It usually means the target was set by an optimistic version of you who was not tired.



Target and minimum. A minimum day is still a completed day.

What a behavior means each day

"Exercise" stays one behavior with one continuous history, while Monday is a 20-minute run and Sunday is a rest day.

In the behavior editor, find **What does it mean each day?**. There are two levels:

- **Default plan** — used on any day without its own plan.
- **Per-weekday plans** — tap a day chip (Mo, Tu, We...) to give that day its own title, details, duration, or mark it a rest day.

A worked example

Day	Plan
Monday	20-minute run
Tuesday	Upper-body workout
Wednesday	30-minute walk
Thursday	Strength training
Friday	Football
Saturday	Stretching
Sunday	<i>Rest day</i>

This is still **one** behavior called Exercise. One completion rate, one streak, one history — but the reminder at 06:30 on Thursday says "Strength training", not "Exercise".

How PACT picks a plan

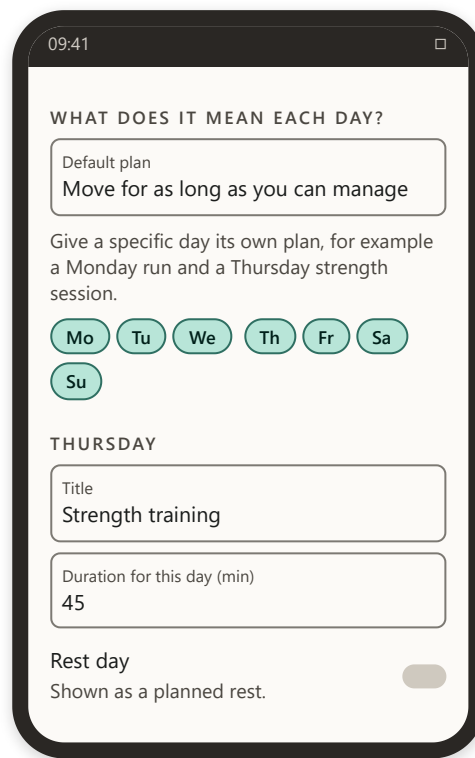
Most specific wins:

```
exact date + slot → exact date → weekday + slot →
weekday → default
```

A day plan only overrides the fields it actually sets. If Tuesday says "Upper body" but leaves the duration blank, it still inherits the behavior's 30 minutes.

REST DAYS ARE PLANNED, NOT SKIPPED

Marking Sunday as a rest day is different from skipping it. A rest day is part of the plan and is shown as such; a skip is an exception to the plan. See chapter 23.



Per-day plans. The behavior stays one thing; the instruction changes.

Reminder sound, vibration and insistence

Sound

Each behavior can have its own sound, so you can learn to recognise which reminder is firing without looking. **Choose a sound** opens the system picker (notification and alarm tones); **Use a file** lets you pick any audio file on the phone.

WHY A CHANGED SOUND NEEDS A MOMENT

Android bakes a notification's sound into a "channel" when it is created and will not let an app edit it afterwards. PACT works around this by creating a fresh channel whenever you change a sound. You may notice a new entry appear under the app's notification categories in Android settings; the old one is removed automatically.

Vibration

Five patterns: Default, Short, Long, Double and Insistent.

How insistent?

Level	What happens
Gentle	A quiet notification you can ignore. No follow-up.
Coach	A heads-up notification, plus one follow-up reminder if you do not answer. The sensible default.
Strong	A full-screen prompt asking for a decision, shown over the lock screen where the phone allows it. Uses the strongest alarm the platform offers.

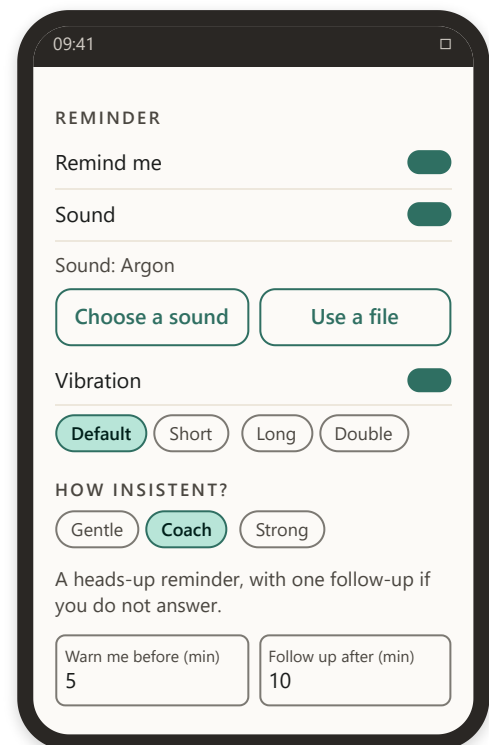
Strong never traps you. The screen always shows a "*Decide later*" option and the back gesture works. PACT will not hold your phone hostage.

Warn me before / Follow up after

Warn me before sends a quiet heads-up a few minutes early, so you can finish what you are doing. *Follow up after* sets how long PACT waits before its single escalation reminder. One escalation only — an app that will not stop is an app you uninstall.

Counts as missed after

If you never answer, the occurrence becomes **Missed** after this many minutes (default 120). A behavior you committed to but never completed gets longer — until the end of the day.



Per-behavior reminder settings.

Recovery settings

Recovery is the heart of the app. These settings control how freely you can push a behavior to a later time.

Setting	Meaning
Allow moving it later	Turns recovery on or off for this behavior. Leave it on unless the behavior genuinely only makes sense at one moment.
Default delay	How far ahead the <i>Later</i> action on the notification pushes it. 30 minutes by default.
Max moves	How many times one occurrence can be pushed before PACT stops offering it. Default 3.

Why there is a limit at all

Without one, "later" becomes a way to avoid deciding. When you hit the limit PACT says:

"You have already moved this 3 times. It may be worth changing the schedule instead."

Which is usually true. Repeatedly pushing the same session is a signal that the scheduled time is wrong, not that you lack willpower — and the coach will eventually suggest a better time based on your own history.

Gradual progression

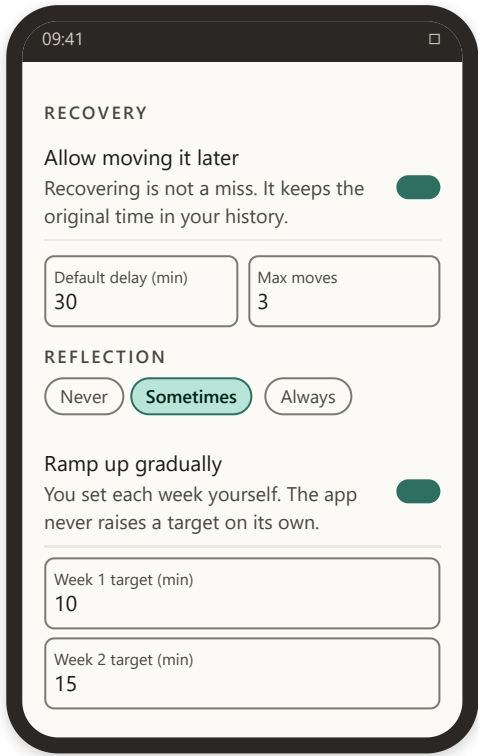
Optional, and entirely manual. Turn on **Ramp up gradually** and set a target per week:

Week 1	10 minutes
Week 2	15 minutes
Week 3	20 minutes
Week 4	30 minutes

PACT never raises a target on its own. If you leave a week blank it holds at the previous value; after the last step it stays there indefinitely.

Reflection

Never, **Sometimes** or **Always**. "Sometimes" means the app asks how it went on the days most likely to be worth a note — a minimum or partial completion — rather than at random.



Recovery limits and the optional manual ramp.

The intervention screen

This is the moment the whole app exists for. Everything else is preparation for these fifteen seconds.

When a behavior comes due, PACT fires an alarm and shows you the intervention. The header band carries the behavior's category colour, so a 06:30 fitness reminder looks different from a 20:00 reading one before you have read a word.

What it tells you, in order

1. **The time and the name** — what this is and when it was planned.
2. **The goal** — which larger thing this serves.
3. **Why it matters** — the sentence you wrote yourself, when you were not tired.
4. **Today's plan** — the day-specific instruction, if you set one.
5. **Planned and Minimum** — the full target and the floor.

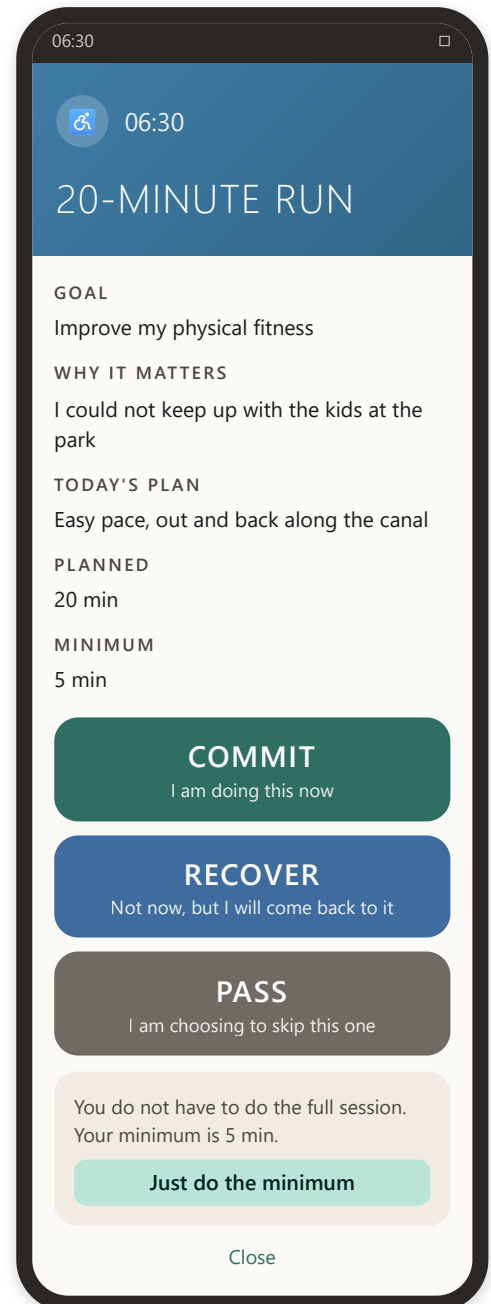
Then three ways forward

They are deliberately large, individually labelled, and different in both colour *and* wording — so they are distinguishable at a glance, half awake, and by someone who cannot rely on colour.

COMMIT	I am doing this now.
RECOVER	Not now, but I will come back to it.
PASS	I am choosing to skip this one.

YOU CAN ALWAYS LEAVE

At the bottom there is a **Close** link — or **Decide later** on a Strong behavior. Leaving without deciding records nothing. The app will not hold your phone hostage, no matter how the reminder is configured.



The intervention. Three decisions, plus the minimum offered before you have to choose.

The three decisions

COMMIT — I am doing this now

The screen changes to **in progress** and waits. When you finish, tap **COMPLETE**. For a quantity behavior you can type how much you actually did; for a checklist you tick items as you go.

You can still change your mind: "*I did the minimum*" and "*Actually, move it later*" are both available from the in-progress screen.

If you commit and then never complete, PACT waits until the end of the day before recording it as missed — longer than the normal grace window, because you did start.

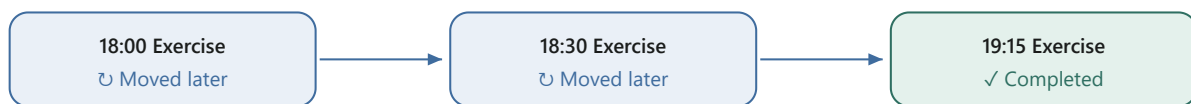
RECOVER — not now, but I will come back to it

Choose 15, 30, 45 minutes, 1 or 2 hours, or type a custom number. A new reminder is set, and it is measured **from now**: if a 06:30 alarm is answered at 08:00 and you ask for 30 minutes, the new one is 08:30, not 07:00.

Recovery may cross midnight; that is expected and supported.

WHAT RECOVERY DOES TO YOUR HISTORY

The original occurrence is **not rewritten**. It is closed as *Moved later*, keeping its planned 18:00 time, and a new linked occurrence is created. Your history shows both: the plan and what actually happened.



The whole chain scores as **one completion**, not two misses and a win.

This is why PACT does not punish you for recovering. If it scored each row separately, moving a session twice would look like two failures — and the app would be discouraging the exact behaviour it is trying to build.

There is a limit (three moves by default). When you hit it, PACT suggests changing the schedule instead, which is usually the honest answer.

PASS — I am choosing to skip this one

A deliberate skip. It is recorded as its own outcome, kept distinct from a miss, and the interface is not judgemental about it.

You can add a reason: *Busy*, *Tired*, *Forgot*, *Not feeling well*, *Unexpected event*, *Not important today*, *Schedule conflict*, *Other* — plus an optional note. Reasons are optional unless you turned on **Ask why when passing** for that behavior.

Passing the same behavior three or more times in a week is something the coach will mention, because it usually means the schedule is wrong rather than that you are failing.

PASS NOW, DO IT ANYWAY LATER?

That is allowed. Open the behavior, find the occurrence in its history, and tap "**I actually did this**". A late completion is still a completion.

Answering from the notification

You do not have to open the app. Every reminder carries its three actions, so a decision costs one tap from the lock screen.

Action	What it does
COMMIT	Same as on the full screen. Marks it in progress.
LATER	Recovers using the behavior's <i>default delay</i> . A notification cannot show a picker, so it uses the number you configured.
PASS	Records a pass with no reason. If that behavior <i>requires</i> a reason, this opens the full screen instead of silently recording a bare pass.

Tapping the notification body — rather than an action — always opens the full intervention screen, where the complete set of recovery times and pass reasons is available.

If the actions are not visible

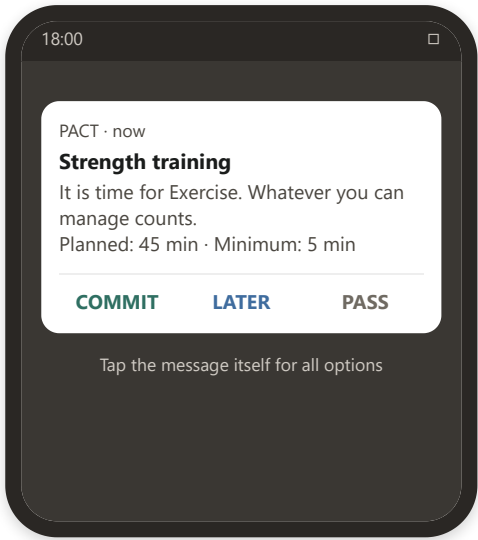
Some launchers, watches and car interfaces collapse notification actions. The body is always tappable, which is the fallback.

Strong behaviours

A Strong behavior additionally asks to show full-screen over the lock screen. On Android 14 and later this is restricted to calendar and alarm apps; if it is not granted, the reminder degrades to a high-priority heads-up notification. Nothing breaks, it is just less insistent.

The follow-up

Coach and Strong behaviours send **one** escalation reminder if you never answered. One, not a stream — an app that will not stop is an app you uninstall.



One tap from the lock screen. No unlock, no app launch.

Home and Today

Home — what do I need to do now?

The dashboard answers one question before anything else. Whatever is due sits at the top in a full-width **Now** card, in the behavior's category colour, with a single obvious button. Everything else on the screen is deliberately quieter than that card.

Underneath, in order:

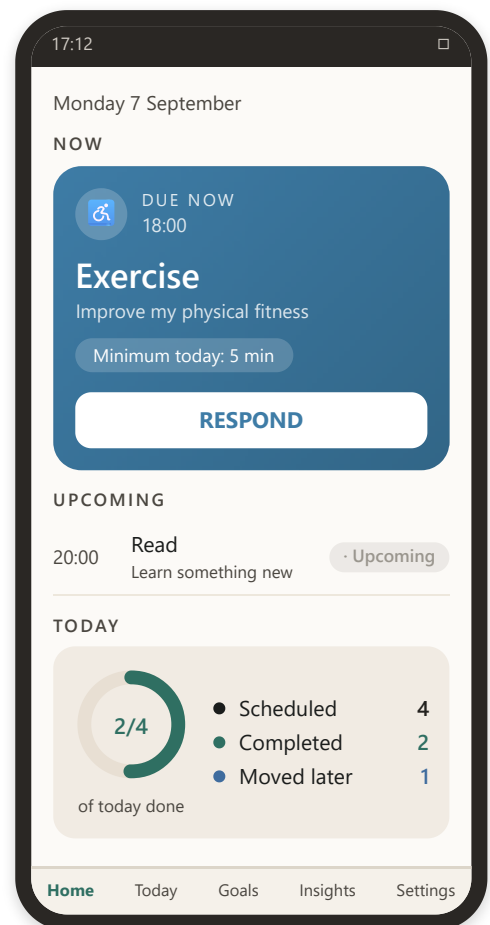
- **Overdue** — the moment passed but nothing was recorded. Shown so nothing disappears silently.
- **Anytime today** — flexible behaviours with no clock time. Tick them off with the *Done* button.
- **Upcoming** — the next few, chronologically.
- **Heads up** — scheduling clashes. A warning only; PACT never moves anything by itself.
- **Today** — a ring showing how much of the day is done, with the counts written beside it.

Today — the whole day in order

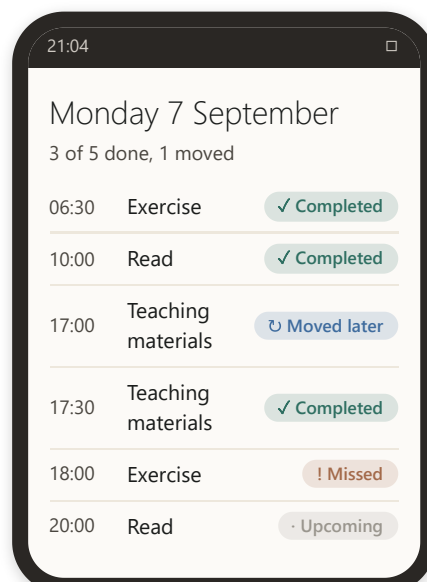
The same day, strictly chronological, with a status pill on every row. Tap an open row to answer it; tap a finished one to open that behavior's detail and history.

WHY THE RING SHOWS A FRACTION, NOT JUST A PERCENTAGE

"2 of 4" and "50%" are not the same information. Two out of four on a quiet day is a different thing from twenty out of forty, and the app should not flatten that.



The dashboard. The Now card is the loudest thing on the screen, on purpose.



Today. The 17:00 session was moved to 17:30 and finished — both rows are kept.

Insights and the recovery score

Two headline rings. The one on the right is the number this app actually cares about.

Completed

The share of resolved occurrences that ended in a completion. Measured over **chains**, so a session that was moved once and then done counts as one completion — not as a miss plus a win.

Recovery score

When you did not act at the planned time, how often did you come back to it?

It is deliberately independent of how often you needed to recover. Needing to move things around is life; whether you return is the skill. A high recovery score with a middling completion rate is a genuinely healthy pattern, and this is the only app-level number that will tell you so.

The rest of the Overview tab

- **Outcomes** — completed, passed and missed as counts, not just percentages.
- **Recent weeks** — a small bar per week, oldest to newest.
- **By day of week** — where Tuesdays quietly fall apart.
- **What the coach notices** — observations, and sometimes a concrete suggestion.
- **By behavior** — every behavior ranked by completion.

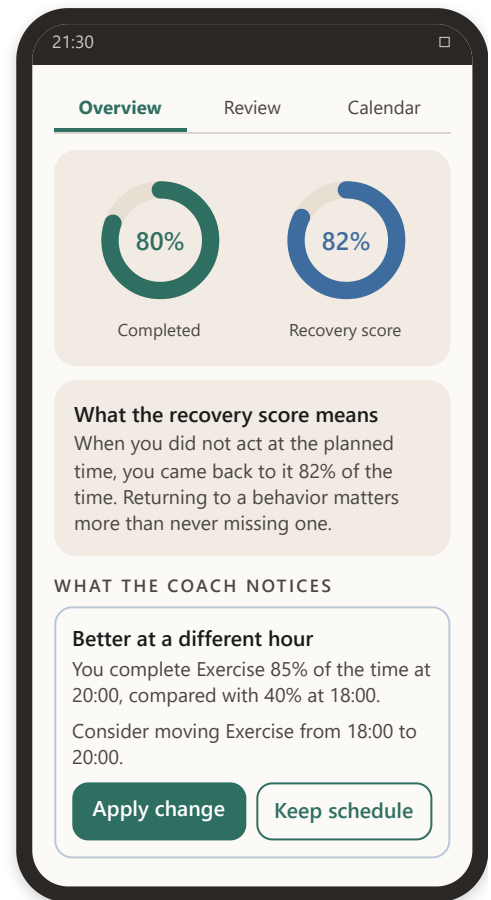
The coach

A fixed set of local rules over your own numbers. It never invents insight the data cannot support, and it says so plainly when there is not enough history yet. Nothing is sent anywhere; there is no model and no network call.

Rules include:

- Above 85% completion → acknowledgement.
- Below 50% after a week or more → suggest reviewing the schedule.
- Recovering more than 40% of the time → the slot may be wrong.
- One hour clearly outperforming another → offer to move it.
- Mostly minimum completions → the target may be too high.

SUGGESTIONS ARE NEVER APPLIED AUTOMATICALLY



Insights. The coach proposes; you decide.

When the coach proposes a schedule change you get two buttons:
Apply change and **Keep schedule**. Nothing moves until you choose.

The weekly review and the calendar

Weekly review

The **Review** tab summarises the last seven days: a bar per behavior showing completed against scheduled, then four totals — completed, moved, passed, missed.

Underneath, the coach's observations for the week, including any schedule suggestions with their **Apply change / Keep schedule** buttons.

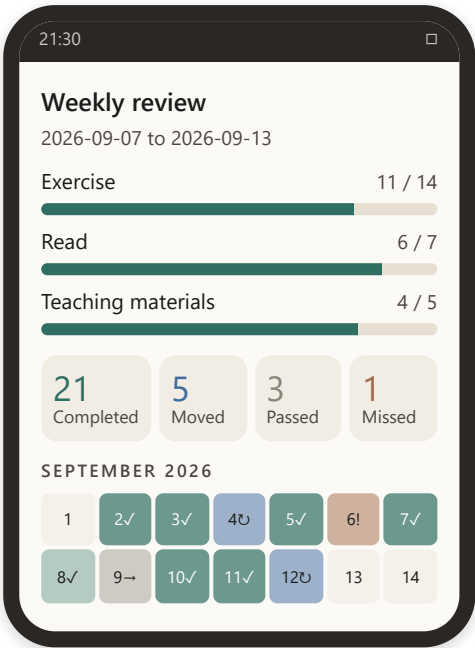
Read it once a week. It is the natural moment to notice that the evening slot is not working and to change it deliberately, rather than drifting.

Calendar

The **Calendar** tab shows a month at a time. Each day is tinted by its dominant outcome and carries a symbol, so the pattern is readable without relying on colour.

✓	Completed — everything planned that day was done.
↺	Moved later — something was recovered.
→	Passed — deliberately skipped.
!	Missed — never answered.

Use the **Previous** and **Next** buttons to move between months. Days with nothing scheduled stay blank — a quiet day is not a failed one.



Weekly review and the month calendar.

Finishing goals, and taking time off

When a goal is done

Tap the **:** menu on any goal card. You get four options, and they are genuinely different things:

Mark as achieved	You finished it. The goal is shown with a tick and struck through, and everything under it — behaviours, history, statistics — is kept exactly as it is. This is what you want most of the time.
Pause	Set aside for now. Nothing is deleted, and you can make it active again from the same menu.
Archive	Filed away and out of the main flow, but still in your records.
Delete	Removes the goal itself. The behaviours under it are kept , along with all of their history — they simply become unassigned. PACT will never destroy months of records because you tidied up a goal.

The same actions are available at the bottom of the goal editor, including a **Mark as achieved** button and **Delete goal**. Deleting always asks first, and the dialog tells you exactly what will happen to the behaviours.

Skips, pauses and holidays

Open a behavior and find **Skip or pause**. Four one-tap options: *Skip today*, *Skip tomorrow*, *Pause a week*, *Away 2 weeks*.

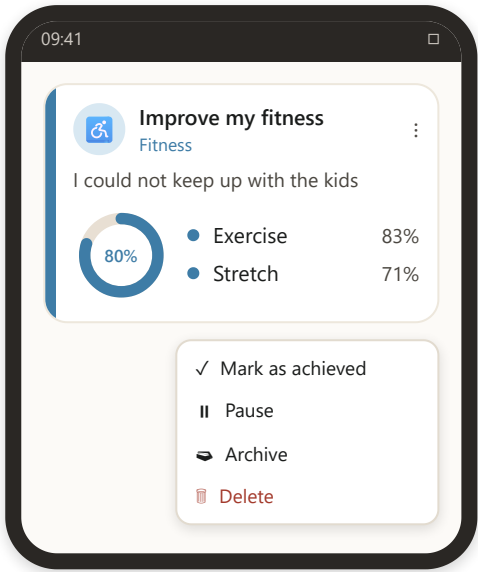
THESE DO NOT CHANGE YOUR SCHEDULE

A skip removes days from generation; the recurring plan underneath is untouched and picks up again automatically afterwards. "Skip 10 September" leaves your daily rule exactly as it was.

Active skips are listed underneath with a **Remove** button, so you can end a pause early.

Pausing a behavior entirely

The **Active** switch on the behavior detail screen stops it firing reminders indefinitely, without deleting anything. Use it for something you have genuinely stopped doing but might return to.



The goal menu. "Mark as achieved" keeps everything; "Delete" removes only the goal.

Settings and backup

Appearance

Light, dark, or follow the system. 24-hour clock on or off. Week starting Monday, Sunday or Saturday.

Reminders

Defaults for new behaviours: sound on/off, vibration on/off, the default sound, and the default insistence level. Individual behaviours can override any of these.

Coach

Personality	Supportive, Professional, Direct, Motivational or Minimal. Changes the wording of intervention and outcome messages, nothing else.
How much	Low, Normal or High — caps how many observations the coach shows at once.
Ask how it went	Never, Sometimes or Always.

Backup: export

Export data writes a single JSON file wherever you choose — Drive, local storage, anywhere. It contains everything: goals, behaviours, schedules, day plans, every occurrence and outcome, and your settings.

DO THIS REGULARLY

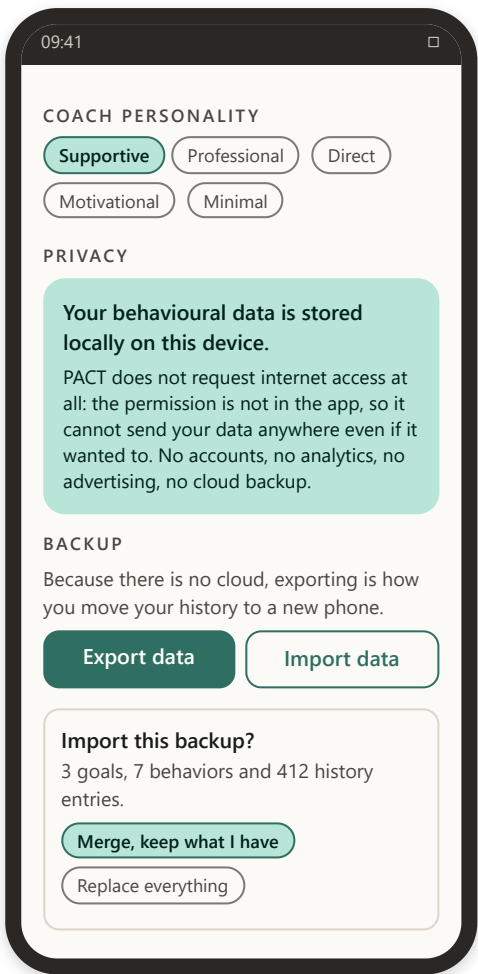
Your history exists only on this phone. PACT switches off Android's automatic cloud backup deliberately, so nothing is copied to your Google account. A lost or reset phone with no export means the history is gone.

Backup: import

Import data reads a file, validates it, and shows you what it contains before writing anything. Then you choose:

- **Merge, keep what I have** — adds only what is missing. Nothing existing is overwritten.
- **Replace everything** — deletes all current data first. The dialog says so plainly.

A file that is damaged, incomplete, or from a newer version of PACT is rejected with an explanation, and your existing data is left



Settings, the privacy statement, and the import confirmation.

untouched.

When reminders do not arrive

Almost always one of five things, in this order of likelihood.

1. Battery optimisation is killing the app

By far the most common cause, especially on Xiaomi, Samsung, Huawei, OnePlus, Oppo and Vivo devices. Their power managers stop background apps aggressively, and no app can reliably work around it.

Fix: Settings → Battery settings → find PACT → set to *Unrestricted* (wording varies). On some phones you must also "lock" the app in the recent-apps view.

2. The exact-alarm permission is not granted

Reminders still fire, but within a ten-minute window rather than at the minute.

Fix: Settings → Alarm permission → allow. The status line above the button tells you the current state.

3. Notifications are blocked

Fix: Settings shows *Notifications: Blocked in system settings*. Go to Android's Settings → Apps → PACT → Notifications and allow them. Check the behavior's own channel is enabled too.

4. Do Not Disturb or a focus mode

Fix: Allow PACT through your DND rules, or use **Strong** enforcement for behaviours that must get through — it uses the platform's alarm channel, which most DND profiles permit.

5. The app was force-stopped

Force-stopping clears all scheduled alarms until the app is opened again. This also happens after some system updates.

Fix: Open PACT. It rebuilds every alarm on launch, on reboot, and after an app update, automatically.

DIAGNOSE IT IN FIFTEEN SECONDS

Settings → **Test my reminder** fires a real alarm through the real pipeline and reports exactly what happened, including whether precision was lost. Start there rather than guessing.

Other things worth knowing

Symptom	Explanation
A changed sound did not take effect	Android bakes the sound into a notification channel and will not let an app edit it. PACT creates a fresh channel; if it still sounds wrong, check the behavior's channel in Android's notification settings.
The custom sound reverted to default	The file moved, was deleted, or access was revoked. PACT checks every sound before use and falls back rather than failing silently.
Reminders shifted after travelling	Intended. Times are kept as wall-clock: 06:30 stays 06:30 in the new time zone.

"App not installed" when
updating

Signature mismatch. Export your data, uninstall, then install the new version.

Outcome states

State	Symbol	Meaning
Upcoming	·	Scheduled, not yet due.
Due now	●	The alarm has fired and is waiting for you.
In progress	●	You committed; it is not finished yet.
Completed	✓	Done, at the full target or the minimum.
Moved later	↺	Recovered. A new occurrence was created; this one is closed.
Passed	→	Deliberately skipped.
Missed	!	Never answered, and the grace window expired.
Cancelled	–	Removed before it could happen.

What counts as what

Number	How it is calculated
Completion rate	Completed chains ÷ resolved chains. A recovered-then-completed chain counts once, as a completion.
Recovery score	Recovered chains that ended completed ÷ all chains that involved a recovery.
Streak	Consecutive <i>scheduled</i> days where everything planned was completed. A Mon/Wed/Fri behavior is not penalised for Tuesday.
Minimum share	Minimum completions ÷ all completions.

Privacy, in one paragraph

PACT does not declare the internet permission. Android therefore refuses every network connection the app could attempt — this is enforced by the operating system, not by the app's good behaviour. There is no account, no analytics, no advertising, no crash reporting and no cloud backup. Your data moves only when you export it yourself.

Android versions

Minimum	Android 8.0 (API 26)
Built against	Android 16 (API 36)
Permissions	Notifications, exact alarms, boot-completed, vibration, full-screen intent

One last thing. If you find yourself dreading the app, something is set wrong — usually a target that is too ambitious or a time that never really worked. Lower the target, move the slot, or set a minimum you could do while ill. The app is supposed to make returning easy, not make missing expensive.

Success is not never missing. Success is returning to the behavior.